
Communicating Your Desires and Limits

Daring to say what you want — and what you don't

4 psychology approaches · 18+ · by EvaTalk

TO BEGIN

Daring to say what you want — and what you don't

Most couples never really talk about sex: we assume, we guess, we stay silent — and frustration builds. Yet communication is the #1 ingredient of a fulfilling intimate life.

This guide helps you dare to express your desires and limits, with ease and respect — for you and your partner.

YOUR INTENTION

What you don't dare say to your partner about intimacy: _____

Silence is costly

No one guesses what feels good to you: without words, your partner moves blindly, and you pile up unspoken things. Silence isn't modesty, it's deferred frustration.

Daring to speak offers the other a map — and gives you the chance to be fulfilled.

Example

Léa thought talking 'would spoil the magic'; instead, their first real conversation unlocked everything.

The unspoken

Which unspoken thing weighs most on your intimate life right now?

Offer the map

Write: 'Saying what I like offers a map, not a reproach.'

Takeaway — Silence isn't modesty — it's deferred frustration.

The thoughts that silence you

'It's awkward to talk about', 'they'll take it badly', 'a good woman doesn't ask': these thoughts lock your voice and deprive you of what you desire.

Reframing them makes speaking possible and light.

Example

'If I ask, he'll be hurt' blocked Sarah; said gently, her desire was in fact warmly received.

Spot the lock

Note a thought that stops you speaking · a fairer version.

A request, not a reproach

Write: 'I have the right to ask for what feels good.'

Takeaway — You have the right to ask for what feels good.

Your desires and limits are legitimate

Your wishes and your refusals have equal value: you have the right to pleasure, AND the right to say no, at any time. Neither needs justifying.

Allowing yourself to feel and to set limits is the basis of a sexuality that respects you.

Example

By finally allowing herself to say 'I don't like that', Fatou felt her confidence — and her pleasure — grow.

My desires

A wish you'd like to express: _____

My limits

A limit you have the right to set, without justifying: _____

Takeaway — Your yes and your no have equal value — no justifying needed.

How to talk about it (and consent)

In practice: pick a moment outside the bed, speak in 'I' ('I'd like...', 'I feel...'), ask questions, and check the other's comfort. Consent isn't a one-time 'yes': it's checked, it can change, and it's always respected.

Real safety is built when each can say yes, no, or 'not tonight'.

Example

By setting a small ritual to talk about their wishes without taboo, Nia and her partner transformed their intimacy.

My way to talk

How and when could you open the conversation, gently?

Consent

Write: 'Consent is checked, can change, and is always respected.'

Takeaway — Speak in 'I', check comfort, respect the yes as much as the no.

Key takeaways

- Silence isn't modesty, it's deferred frustration.
- You have the right to ask for what feels good.
- Your yes and your no have equal value.
- Talk outside the bed, in 'I', without reproach.
- Consent is checked, can change, is always respected.
- Real safety grows when each can say 'not tonight'.

Your turn

My voice

The weighing unspoken	The silencing thought

My expression

My desire	My limit

YOUR JOURNEY

Your 4-week plan

Week 1

Spot my unspoken things.

Week 2

Reframe the thoughts that silence me.

Week 3

Recognize my desires and limits as legitimate.

Week 4

Open a real conversation, gently.

YOUR PLAN

Your action plan

My 'I have the right to ask' line:

The desire I express:

The limit I set:

Your voice belongs in bed as elsewhere — dare it.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool for adults (18+) — not therapy or medical advice. Everything here is about choice and mutual consent: nothing is ever an obligation. In case of pain, health concern or persistent difficulty, consult a professional (doctor, sex therapist). © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.